

GREY BANNER ALERT



Serious Incident – Final Notice

CRITICAL RISK: N/A

Date of Incident	11/04/2026	Time of Incident	6:15 AM
Directorate / Region	RMO MWG	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
Safe Event Type	Injury / Illness	Safe Incident Number	INC-0000003
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate
Reportable to WorkSafe	Yes	Type of Notifiable Incident	Serious injury or illness that a medical practitioner considers likely to prevent normal work for at least 10 days

Incident Short Description	Shoulder Injury Sustained While Exiting Vehicle on Road Shoulder
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Executive Summary

On Saturday, 11 April 2026, at 6:15 AM, a Traffic Controller (IP) was setting up traffic management signage for a road widening project when they exited a vehicle on the passenger side. As the IP stepped onto the soft roadside batter, their feet slipped from underneath them. In an attempt to regain balance, the IP grabbed the vehicle door with their right hand and reached behind with their left hand to grab the roll bar. The IP immediately experienced pain in their left shoulder while recovering their balance.

The IP completed the site setup; however, due to ongoing shoulder pain they were unable to continue working and reported the injury to their crew leader.

First aid was administered and the IP was transported to the emergency department for assessment. Initial X-rays did not identify any fractures; however, further assessment by ultrasound was required. The IP was prescribed medication and certified unfit for work for two weeks, resulting in a Lost Time Injury (LTI)



Location of vehicle on road shoulder and reenactment photo taken at the same time of day, the following morning.

Contributing Factors

- Generic risk assessment highlights the risks associated with entering and exiting vehicles where hazardous ground conditions may be present but do not provide specific controls for managing hazardous ground conditions during vehicle entry and exit
- Traffic controllers were aware of potential ground hazards; however, following the top-up and compaction stage of works, the changed shoulder conditions were not identified as requiring additional controls.
- Minimal clearance from the traffic lane due to staging of works resulted in the passenger door being situated above a small drop-off at the edge of the shoulder.
- Although Traffic Controllers report being able to see well enough in the pre-dawn light the sun was not up. It is possible this may have contributed to the event.
- IP did not observe ground conditions adequately prior to exiting the vehicle so did not see the drop off consisted of loose material.
- IP new to industry and while basic traffic control tasks are understood, IP had minimal experience responding to changing work site conditions.

Corrective Actions

- Issue a safety alert to traffic management personnel highlighting risks associated with vehicle entry and exit where roadside shoulders are uneven, soft or unstable.
- Reinforce through pre-starts and team communications the requirement to assess ground conditions before exiting vehicles and apply appropriate controls where hazards are identified.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations